

Module -02

Oral communication**Syllabus****Oral communication**

Oral Communication: Meaning, Principles of successful oral communication, Barriers to oral communication, Conversation control, Reflection and Empathy: two sides of effective oral communication. Modes of Oral Communication, Effectiveness of oral communication. Listening as a Communication Skill: Approaches to listening, how to be a better listener, Process of listening, Nonverbal communication: Meaning, classification.

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Definition of Oral Communication

- Oral communication, also known as Verbal Communication, is the interchange of verbal messages between sender and receiver.
- Oral communication, while primarily referring to spoken verbal communication, can also employ visual aids and non-verbal elements to support the conveyance of meaning.
- Oral communication includes speeches, presentations, discussions, and aspects of interpersonal communication.
- As a type of face-to-face communication, body language and choice tonality play a significant role, and may have a greater impact upon the listener than informational content.
- This type of communication also garners immediate feedback.

The study of human behavior

- 70% spent in communicating
- 45% listening
- 30% speaking
- 16% reading
- 9% writing

Its necessary that people in business learn to use this time to their best advantage for creating and sustaining good relationship through their ability to listen and speak effectively.

Need for learning oral communication skills

- To help problem solving

- To resolve conflict
- To influence people to work together.
- To persuade others to be involved in organizational goals
- To be assertive without being aggressive
- To develop listening skills
- To be an effective negotiator
- To make a proposal

Oral communication requires skillful control of tone, voice, pitch and precise use of words.

Comparative Advantages of Oral Communication

<u>Oral communication</u>	<u>Written Communication</u>
• More personal and informal • Makes immediate impact • Provides opportunity for interaction and feedback • Helps to correct • Better for conveying feelings and emotions.	• Better for complex and difficult • Better for keeping records of messages exchanged • Provides opportunity to refer back • Can be read at receivers convince • Can be revised before transmitting • Can be circulated

Limitations of Oral and Written Communication

Oral communication

- Demands ability to think coherently as you speak
- A word once uttered can not be taken back
- Hard to control voice pitch and tone, especially under stress, excited or anger
- Very difficult to be conscious of body language

Written Communication

- Never known if the message is ever read
- Impersonal and remote
- Immediate feedback is not available for the correction on the spot

- Reader is not helped by non-verbal cues that contribute to the total message
- Many people do not reading

Principles of Successful Oral Communication

1. Brevity.
2. Clarity.
3. Choosing Precise words.
4. Avoids Meaning less Phrases.
5. Sequences.
6. Avoid Jargons.
7. Avoid Verbosity.
8. 7 C's of Communication.
9. Prepositions.
10. Adjectives & Verbs.

Characteristics of Effective Oral Communication

- Consider the objective
- Think about the interest level of the receiver
- Be sincere
- Use simple language, familiar words
- Be brief and precise
- Avoid vagueness
- Give full facts: Great Delivery
- Assume nothing
- Use polite words: speaking without hurting
- Cut out insulting message
- Say something interesting and pleasing to the respondent
- Allow time to respond
- Listener participation
- Art of speaking

The Nature of the Spoken Word

- The speaker should converse slowly, with proper semantic pause, to enable the listener receive and register in his mind what ever is heard.
- Research has established that an individual speaks nearly 125 words a minute, and the brain of the listener processes nearly 4-5 times more rapidly.
- An important principle of oral communication is to speak fluently, without long pause or non-stop rushing through word.

Fluency

- Fluency usually means ease as a condition of speaking.
- The listener does not have to strain his mind to receive, register and interpret the message heard.

Barriers of effective oral communication

1. Status
2. Complexes
3. Closed and all-knowing mind
4. Poor retention
5. Premature evaluation and hurried conclusions as distortions
6. Abstracting
7. Slant
8. Cognitive dissonance
9. Language barrier

Conversation Control

- conversation control involves skills of listening and talking in a positive and meaningful way at an appropriate time.
- techniques of changing the direction of conversation smoothly.
- The ability to allow a discussion to develop along key issues in an uninterrupted way towards the desired end.

Conversation Skills Control

- How to sell or buy
- How to negotiate
- How to interview
- How to participate in a meeting
- How to disagree without being rude
- How to protest without offending
- How to compliment/ praise
- How to respond to personal criticism

Ability to notice cues/clues

A cue is a keyword or phrase a person uses when he/she wants to indicate that something is important to him/ her.

Interpreting signs and signals

- While speaking, we all unconsciously keep moving our hands, eyes, head, legs, and other parts of the body or engage in some other non-verbal behavior.
- Signs consist of visual indicators such as frown, smile, eye movements and so on.
- Signals are behavioral indicators others can give us.

Parallel conversation

We engage in conversation to explore something. It may be to find out facts, or know the issues, or seek out situations.

Sequential Conversation

When we converse in a skillfully controlled way, we make statements that are sequence to what is said by other person. There is a logical link between the statements made by the speaker and the listener. Sequential conversation between two persons is always fruitful.

Reflection and Empathy

The body language should show the real interest in speech. Make eye contact. Lean forward. And speak as a person with genuine feeling of other person with concern.

- **Sense of time as a Skill:** The time limits announced in formal oral activities should be strictly observed. Your pace of conversation or presentation should not exceed 110-120 words per minute.
- **Summarizing as an integral part of oral communication:** Before you express your opinion or give your response to other's opinion, you should be able to recognize, analyse and evaluate what the other person has said.

Two sides of Effective Oral Communication

- Listening
- Presenting

Modes of Oral Communication

- **A scripted or formal speech.** This mode may allow (or require) the chance to utilize notecards, a teleprompter, and/or memorization skills. Although resources are available, avoid simply reading information, since this hinders the important connection you make with your

audience. Eye contact is necessary to engage with those in attendance. Pacing depends on time provided and using it wisely. An advantage for a prepared speech is practicing/rehearsing the material. Outline the various points of the talk to estimate how much time to spend on each segment, and factor in the possibility for audience questions and technical difficulties to develop a presentation that is not rushed to confuse the audience, nor presented at a snail's pace to bore the audience.

- **An extemporaneous or impromptu speech.** Occasionally, you may need to offer a quick presentation or update to a supervisor, client, or coworker. Perhaps you have encountered a potential client at a conference, or maybe your boss or peer has a looming deadline for a report they must write. You might even be asked to respond to an emergency or sudden development that affects your project. In these situations, you will not have the time to create a full script or even an outline. Without the aid of material resources such as slides or visuals, your focus must be directed toward presenting relevant and related content in a smooth manner to avoid straying from the purpose of the communication. Think of keywords that highlight your message in order to maintain consistency in the delivery of information as you navigate from one point to the next.
- **A guided discussion.** In this mode, you are responsible for maintaining a relevant thread of content while people in attendance pose questions, provide information, and analyze the subject matter being covered. This is a facilitator role in which what you say is equally important to listening to foster a consistent discussion. Prior knowledge of the topic at hand and inquiries that may arise during the discussion help create a positive experience for the audience. Preparation for this mode includes brainstorming and preparing engaging questions and researching answers to audience queries that are likely to arise. Guided discussions may be enhanced by the use of visuals, such as questions, directions, or being projected on a screen.

Effectiveness of Oral Communication

1. Clear pronunciation
2. Brevity
3. Precision
4. Conviction
5. Logical sequence

6. Appropriate word choice
7. Avoid hackneyed phrases & clichés
8. Natural voice
9. Finding the right register

Listening

- Listening is an important component of conversation control.
- Definition of listening: It is a physical and psychological process that involves choosing to listen, understanding, and responding to symbolic messages from others.
- To be able to understand appreciate the other person.
- Allow the communicator to talk freely without interrupted.

Characteristics of Good Listener and Poor Listener

Good listeners

- Do not interrupt
- Remain patient
- Make eye contact
- Show interest
- Low attentive
- Concentrate
- Ask open question

Poor listeners

- Over- talkative
- Inattentive
- Interrupt
- Impatient to talk
- Poor concentration

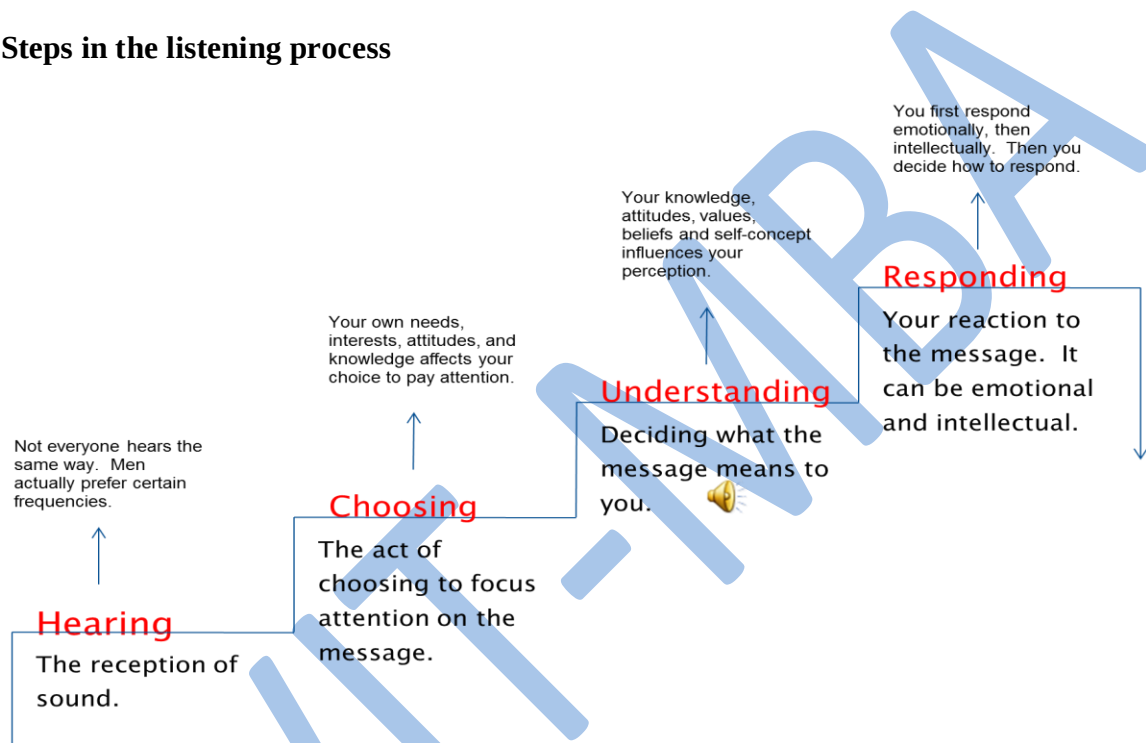
Purposes for Listening

- To distinguish sounds.
- For enjoyment.
- To understand a message.
- To evaluate a message.

Principles of listening

- Listen Patiently.
- Understanding speakers feelings.
- Restatement & Summary.
- Time for discussion.
- Avoid expressing views.
- Less explanation.

Steps in the listening process



Presenting

- Cut down habits such as interrupting or showing little interest.
- Its advisable to shun 'yes', 'but' and 'ifs'.
- Try to encourage the other person by body language.

Be an Effective Presenter

- Try to present facts
- Not your opinions
- Keep to the point
- Keep the listener's interest in mind
- Support your argument with suitable examples
- Ask for feed back and answer questions honestly
- Make eye contact

Non -Verbal Communication is the message or response not expressed or sent in words - hints , suggestions , indications.

- Actions speak louder than words.
- “What you are speaks so loudly that I cannot hear what you say” -Ralph Waldo Emerson
- There is a distinction between the meanings we ‘give’ in words and the meanings we ‘give –off’ in NV signals.
- Non -Verbal signals are unconscious parts of our behavior which is a deeply rooted part in our entire makeup.
- In fact, it is the most basic part of our personality.
- Behavior has no opposite, i.e. there is no such thing as non-behavior.
- NVC is the unspoken communication that goes on in every Face-to-Face encounter with another human being.
- It is recognized as the route to discover what the other side wants, without them ever saying it, like a secret way into their soul.
- NVC stands for the innermost, instinctual form of human communication.
- Communication researcher Mehrabian found that only 7% of a message’s effect are carried by words ; listeners receive the other 93% through non -verbal means.
- Bird whistell suggested that spoken words account for not more than 30-35% of all our social interactions.
- Over 65 percent of the social meaning of the messages we send to others are communicated non-verbally.

Kinesic Communication- Body Language

- Kinesic communication is a message conveyed through non-verbal acts.
- Kinesic communication is also know as body language or body talk
- Non-verbal clues influence the perception and understanding of the verbal message.
- The bodily gestures, postures, and facial expressions by which a person communicates non verbally with others”.

KINESICS:

- ♦POSTURE
- ♦GESTURE
- ♦FACIAL EXPRESSIONS
- ♦GAZE / EYE CONTACT

Body Language

- Facial expression(s)
- Eyes
- Lips
- Arms
- Hands
- Fingers

Classification of non-verbal Communication

- Symbols of Body Language
- Face facts
- Positive Gestures
- Negative gestures
- Signs of nervousness
- Gestures of aggressiveness
- Gestures of rudeness
- Gestures showing self importance
- Gestures showing lack of good sense
- Gestures showing superiority of position

Lateral Gestures

- Physical setting:

arrangements of furniture

- Dress:

pay attention to clothes when its needed to impress people

- Personal space:

space indicates the level of formality, informality, intimacy or distance between them
